PIES & TARTS · SWEET

Lemon Blueberry Tart

Lemon condensed-milk filling with a blueberry swirl on shortbread.

SERVES **8 TO 10** · ACTIVE **1 HR**
TOTAL **ABOUT 4 HR WITH CHILLING**
PAN **9 IN TART PAN** · OVEN **350°F (175°C)**

BEFORE YOU START

- Make the blueberry sauce first. Once the crust is in the oven, everything moves fast.
- Preheat the oven to **350°F** (**175°C**) while the sauce cooks.
- Check the condensed milk: it must be full-fat sweetened, and a full 14 oz can. Evaporated, fat-free or a short can leaves the filling runny.
- Don't use a springform pan; the crust leaks.

INGREDIENTS

Blueberry sauce

	1 tsp	Cornstarch
	2 tsp	Lemon juice or water
140 g	1 cup	Blueberries fresh or frozen, not thawed
	2 tsp	Granulated sugar

Shortbread crust

113 g	1/2 cup	Unsalted butter melted
50 g	1/4 cup	Granulated sugar
	1 tsp	Pure vanilla extract
	1/4 tsp	Salt
125 g	1 cup	All-purpose flour spooned and leveled

Filling

397 g	1 can	Sweetened condensed milk 14 oz, full-fat
	6 Tbsp	Lemon juice about 2 lemons
	1 tsp	Lemon zest about 1 lemon
	1	Large egg yolk

To serve (optional)

Lemon slices, blueberries, leftover sauce, whipped cream

METHOD

Blueberry sauce

1. Stir the cornstarch into the lemon juice with a fork until dissolved; set aside.
2. Warm the blueberries and sugar in a small saucepan over medium heat for **3 min**, stirring now and then and mashing the berries against the pan to break them down.
3. Stir in the slurry and cook **2 min** more, then take off the heat and leave at room temperature until the filling goes in. It makes 1/2 to 2/3 cup; about half goes in the tart and the rest is for serving.
   ✓ *Thickened*

Crust

4. In a medium bowl, stir together the melted butter, sugar, vanilla and salt. Add the flour and mix until fully combined.
   ✓ *Thick and a little greasy, as it should be*
5. Press firmly and evenly into an ungreased 9-inch tart pan, across the bottom and up the sides. It looks like too little but it stretches. The base of a measuring cup helps, though it can stick.
6. Bake at **350°F** (**175°C**).
   WAIT **15 MIN**
   ✓ *Edges just barely browned*
7. Poke a few fork holes across the warm crust, not all the way through, so the filling has something to grip. Leave the oven on.

Filling and bake

8. Whisk the condensed milk, lemon juice, zest and egg yolk until smooth. Pour into the still-warm crust.
9. Stir the sauce to loosen it, since it thickens as it sits; give it **5 to 10 sec** in the microwave if needed (warm is fine). Spoon about half over the filling and swirl with a toothpick or knife, then shimmy the pan back and forth two or three times to settle it.
10. Bake at **350°F** (**175°C**). Err toward underbaking; it keeps firming in the fridge, and overbaked filling turns rubbery.
    WAIT **17 TO 19 MIN**
    ✓ *Center stops jiggling when you tap the pan; top still a little tacky*

Chill and serve

11. Cool completely on a rack, then refrigerate uncovered. Cover it if chilling longer than **2 hr**, up to **1 day**.
    WAIT **AT LEAST 2 HR IN THE FRIDGE**
12. Remove the pan sides, slice, and serve with the reserved sauce and any garnishes.

NOTES

Make ahead & storage

- Leftovers keep tightly covered in the fridge up to **1 week**.
- The whole tart can be baked and chilled a day ahead. It also freezes up to **3 months**; thaw overnight in the fridge.
- The sauce and filling can be made ahead and refrigerated (rewarm the sauce to loosen it), but don't prebake the crust. The filling needs a warm crust to stick.

Substitutions

- Pan: a 9-inch pie dish works with the same bake times but slices less cleanly. A graham crust doesn't work; it collapses under this filling.
- Smooth sauce: strain it through a fine-mesh sieve to remove skins and lumps.
- Lime: swap lime juice and zest for the lemon. The swirl is optional.
- Strawberry: 1 cup chopped fresh or frozen strawberries in place of the blueberries.
- Raspberry or blackberry: 1 cup berries plus 1 extra tsp sugar in the sauce (3 tsp total). Strain out the seeds.
- Mini tarts: divide the crust among about 10 mini tart pans, pressing it into the bottoms only. Bake **8 min** on a sheet pan and skip the fork holes. Fill the warm crusts, dot and swirl with sauce, and bake **9 to 10 min** until the centers set. Cool, then chill at least **1 hr**.
- Orange isn't recommended (too sweet without the tang). Grapefruit is untested.

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SWEET
CITRUS · FRUIT · TANGY · MAKE-AHEAD
FREEZER-FRIENDLY

Adapted from Sally McKenney, sallysbakingaddiction.com/lemon-blueberry-tart.
Method rewritten and condensed for personal kitchen use.